You Busy This Afternoon?

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by TheSofterGentlerMe

Summary

Catra is spending a little her time relaxing in a chair when Adora comes in to tell her about the benefits at her new job and how she knows just how to get Catra in on them. They just have to do some special paperwork first. Like a marriage license.

Notes

Shall we?

Thanks to PinkStorm for the idea!

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra was curled up in a chair by the window, reading through an old blacksmithing book she'd found at the local library's book sale. She had the apartment to herself that morning as Adora was out at her new job at the university and Catra had the day off. She was reading a particularly interesting bit on the book about tempering steel when she heard a key in the lock. As she looked up, Adora came in.

"Quit already?" Catra said.

"It was just orientation," Adora said and Catra sat up a little straighter as she noticed Adora seemed a bit more animated than normal. "We actually got done a bit early. What are you doing this afternoon?"

"Same thing I'm doing right now," Catra said. "Why? What's up?"

Adora didn't answer at first as she started rummaging in her messenger bag. After a few seconds, she came up with a sheaf of papers and handed them to Catra.

"OK, it's your benefits package, I think?" Catra said, looking at the papers.

"Uh, yeah," Adora said as she fidgeted a little. "So do you want to go get married this afternoon?"

Catra stopped for a moment and then laughed as she said, “Are you serious?”

Adora nodded as she said, “Yeah. I mean, we got engagement rings years ago, we’ve talked about it before, and I can add you to my insurance with this new job if we’re married.”

Catra sat down her book and the paperwork on the little table beside her as she said, “Well, that’s so romantic.”

Adora’s face fell as she said, “I wasn’t trying to be flippant about it.”

Catra stood up and stepped over to Adora and took her in her arms and gave her a kiss.

“I know you weren’t,” Catra said. “Yes, Adora Weaver, let’s get married this afternoon and get me some insurance. And as a side deal, I’ll upgrade from girlfriend to wife.”

Adora laughed as she said, “Now who’s being flippant?”

“Hey, if we do this, I get to yell things like, ‘That’s my *wife!’* so trust me, I’m deadly serious about this,” Catra said as she rocked Adora back and forth a little bit.

Adora leaned her forehead against Catra's as she said, "OK, that would be pretty awesome."

"It would be," Catra said before kissing her again. She got quiet for a moment before she went on, a bit hesitant. "Are you sure about this?"

"Catra, we've lived together for years now," Adora said. "Yes, I'm sure."

"I know but this seems… big," Catra replied.

It was Adora's turn to be quiet as she thought for a moment.

"You know," Adora said, "we've had our ups and downs but I can't imagine not being with you. Why not make it official?"

Catra hugged her tight before kissing her again as she said, "I agree. Besides, this way, you know I'll never leave you."

Adora looked at her with a raised eyebrow as she said, "OK, that's a weird thing to say but why?"

Catra gave a big grin as she said, "Because you know how much I hate paperwork and there's no way I'm going through all the stuff

required for a divorce.”

Adora laughed as she said, “OK, that’s fair. In that case, let’s go get this done so I have you locked in.”

“You want to get Glimmer and Bow in on this?” Catra said.

“They’re up at her parent’s house right now,” Adora said. “By the time they get here, the courthouse will be closed. We’ll have a party with them and everyone else later.”

“OK, that sounds good,” Catra said. “Let’s do this then.”

The two spent a little time changing into the fanciest clothes they had. For Adora, that meant a basic gray suit she’d got for school and then wore for her recent graduation for her bachelors. For Catra, it was a dark blue button down shirt tucked into a pair of dark khaki pants. She rummaged around for a moment until she found the matching tie she’d worn to Adora’s graduation and got it on.

“Look good?” Catra said with her arms out to the side.

“You look amazing,” Adora said, stepping up to give her a kiss. “Ready?”

“Oh! Wait! One last thing,” Catra said and went out into the living room.

Adora followed her and watched as Catra flipped open the top of her toolbox and started stacking hammers, tongs, and other odds and ends next to it. She watched as Catra pulled a small bundle wrapped in a cloth out of the bottom of the box and started unwrapping it.

“What’s that?” Adora said as she stepped over as she saw an old box of nails. “Is this some blacksmith tradition thing? Bring a nail to your wedding?”

“That’s just the box I used,” Catra said as she opened it up. “I made these a little while ago and was holding on to them for Christmas. Figured this is the right time.”

Catra held up two plain silver rings in her hand.

“You made those?” Adora said, as she reached down and picked one up. The ring was simple with no ornamentation but she could see herself in the highly polished silver. “Are these real silver?”

“Yeah, I did and yeah, they are,” Catra said as she stood up. “I built a little foundry and some casts at work, tried it out with some aluminum, and then got my hands on some old silver coins. Boom, rings.”

“They’re great,” Adora said and hugged Catra tight. “Thank you.”

“Enough of this, let’s go get married,” Catra said.

“Yes!” Adora said.

It was a short drive to the county courthouse. They were both surprised to not find a line for the clerk but that didn’t slow them down. They paid the fee, showed their ID’s and then the clerk said, “OK, are either of you changing your name?”

Catra was saying no when Adora spoke up.

“Yes.”

“Wait, what?” Catra said.

“Yes, I want to take your last name,” Adora said.

The clerk looked between the two with a neutral expression, waiting to see what would happen.

“Seriously? You want to be Adora Manzana?” Catra replied.

“I have been since that first night on the dock,” Adora said as she took Catra’s hand. Catra blinked back tears as she leaned forward and gave Adora a kiss.

“OK, that’s sweet,” the clerk said in a deadpan voice before going on to tell them how the name change was accomplished.

After that they sat and waited a few minutes before they were called into a little room. Adora gave one of the clerks her phone for a few photos of them and then they swore some simple vows before a judge.

“I pronounce you married,” the judge said with a smile. “I think you know this part I bet.”

And so they kissed.

End Notes

OK, so in looking things up for this, I found out the county where I live (and the surrounding ones as well it seems) no longer do courthouse marriages. I have a feeling this was because of marriage equality and the fact I live in an incredibly conservative state. Of course, it's the same state that Catra and Adora live in so I'm indulging in a little fantasy here where they're able to get married without any hassle at the local courthouse.

Catra's joke about not getting divorced because she hates paperwork is one my wife and I had early on in our marriage. I thought it'd be appropriate here.

So, PinkStorm mentioned in a comment how they hoped they'd get to see a Catradora wedding in this series. I wasn't going to do one. I had the story that's going to go up after this and then the final story but I thought, "You know, I have a really great idea of how their wedding is going to go." So hence, Adora sees she can get Catra on her insurance but only if they're married and says, "You know what, we've been meaning to. Let's do it."

I will say that while I didn't write it, they will have a big party with all of their friends to celebrate. Will Glimmer and Bow be salty that they missed the wedding? I think so but not terribly. They'll just be happy for their friends.

I really had fun with this one and I hope you did as well. Thanks for reading!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!